

- a. I am hiring for the role of Chief AI Officer at a University. Create a job description for this role.

Here's a strong, modern job description you can use and adapt for a university setting:

Chief AI Officer (CAIO)

Location: [University Name, City, State]

Reports to: President / Provost / CIO

Position Overview

The Chief AI Officer (CAIO) is a senior executive responsible for shaping and executing the university's artificial intelligence (AI) strategy across academic, research, and administrative domains. This role provides visionary leadership to ensure AI is leveraged ethically, responsibly, and effectively to enhance teaching, learning, research, and institutional operations.

The CAIO will work collaboratively with faculty, IT leadership, and administrative units to position the university as a leader in AI innovation while maintaining strong governance, compliance, and ethical standards.

Key Responsibilities

Strategic Leadership

- * Develop and implement a comprehensive university-wide AI strategy aligned with institutional goals.
- * Identify opportunities to integrate AI into teaching, research, student services, and operations.
- * Advise executive leadership on emerging AI trends, risks, and opportunities.

Academic & Research Integration

- * Partner with faculty to support AI-driven curriculum development and interdisciplinary programs.
- * Promote AI research initiatives and facilitate external funding opportunities.
- * Foster collaboration across departments to advance AI scholarship.

Operational Innovation

- * Oversee the deployment of AI solutions to improve administrative efficiency (e.g., admissions, advising, finance, HR).

- * Ensure AI technologies enhance student experience and outcomes.
- * Evaluate and manage AI tools, platforms, and vendors.

Ethics, Governance & Compliance

- * Establish and enforce policies for responsible AI use, including fairness, transparency, and data privacy.
- * Ensure compliance with legal and regulatory requirements.
- * Lead AI risk management and governance frameworks.

Partnerships & External Engagement

- * Build partnerships with industry, government, and other academic institutions.
- * Represent the university in national and global AI initiatives.
- * Engage alumni and donors to support AI-related initiatives.

Team Leadership

- * Build and lead a cross-functional AI team (data scientists, engineers, policy experts).
- * Provide professional development and training opportunities for faculty and staff.
- * Promote a culture of innovation and continuous learning.

Qualifications

Required

- * Advanced degree (PhD preferred) in Artificial Intelligence, Computer Science, Data Science, or related field.
- * 10+ years of progressive leadership experience in AI, data science, or digital transformation.
- * Demonstrated success leading large-scale, cross-functional initiatives.
- * Strong understanding of AI technologies (machine learning, generative AI, data infrastructure).
- * Experience with governance, ethics, and regulatory considerations in AI.

Preferred

- * Experience in higher education or research institutions.
- * Proven track record of securing research funding or leading grant-funded projects.
- * Familiarity with academic governance structures.
- * Strong publication or thought leadership record in AI-related fields.

Key Competencies

- * Visionary leadership and strategic thinking
- * Collaboration and stakeholder engagement
- * Ethical judgment and integrity
- * Change management and innovation leadership
- * Excellent communication and public speaking skills

Compensation & Benefits

- * Competitive executive salary commensurate with experience
- * Comprehensive benefits package
- * Relocation assistance (if applicable)

Equal Opportunity Statement

[University Name] is an equal opportunity employer committed to fostering an inclusive and diverse academic community.

If you want, I can tailor this specifically for a **research-heavy university**, a **teaching-focused institution**, or even a **public vs. private university**—the emphasis shifts quite a bit depending on that.

b. .

Homayoun Valafar

Leads USC's AI Institute, already coordinating AI strategy across disciplines

Experience aligning research, education, and applied AI initiatives

Closest functional match to a university-wide CAIO role today

Amit Sheth

Nationally recognized AI leader with deep expertise in knowledge graphs and semantic AI

Proven track record building AI programs and securing research funding

Strong external reputation, useful for partnerships and positioning USC as an AI leader

Biplav Srivastava

Expertise in responsible AI, governance, and enterprise AI systems

Experience bridging academia and real-world AI applications

Well-suited for establishing ethical frameworks and institutional AI policy

Jianjun Hu

Strong background in machine learning, data science, and interdisciplinary AI

Experience working across domains, enabling broad campus collaboration

Capable of advancing both research and applied AI initiatives

Leonardo Bonilha

Leader in applying AI in healthcare and clinical research

Experience with cross-functional teams and real-world AI deployment

Brings a translational perspective (research → impact), valuable for university-wide adoption

c. .

Metrics used: Ability to turn AI usage into a tool for success. If they can't turn an AI into a helpful tool that aligns with the Universities needs, it will never happen.

Good understanding of modern AI systems. They need to know how AI works in order to use it.

They should know how to guide the AI to the right kind of decisions, and know how to reduce risks as much as possible when using the AI. They should know how to make good decisions for themselves and the university without help from AI in the process of making them, otherwise we may as well just be asking the AI to run the entire University.

Experience designing AI and the ability to check for fairness and transparency in the AI. Letting AI do things could lead to some risks for the University. They should know how to make sufficient guardrails to prevent conflict from legal and ethical laws.

Ability to check the AIs ethics and prevent bias. The AI needs to be ethical when guiding people in the University. They should know how to find and reduce unfair bias as much as possible because unfair bias would give nonoptimal results to the users.

Engagement with the public. They should be able to explain an AIs decisions and ensure they can clearly communicate with users if they question the AIs responses.

Response and prompt:

I am hiring for the role of Chief AI Officer at a University. Score all the candidates listed from best to worst. Use metrics based on those given in the provided txt file.

Here is the list of candidates: Homayoun Valafar

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Using the criteria from your file (AI as a strategic tool, technical understanding, design/governance, ethics & bias mitigation, and public engagement), here's a structured evaluation and ranking.

🏆 Final Ranking (Best → Worst)

1. **Homayoun Valafar**

Why #1: He is already doing much of the CAIO job in practice.

AI as a tool for institutional success: Excellent — already coordinating university-wide AI strategy

Understanding of modern AI systems: Strong — leads an AI institute

AI design, fairness, transparency: Good — implied through leadership role, though less explicitly specialized

Ethics & bias mitigation: Moderate–Strong

Public engagement: Strong — cross-disciplinary leadership requires communication

👉 **Verdict:** Best immediate fit. Minimal ramp-up time, strongest alignment with *operational leadership*.

2. **Amit Sheth

Why #2: Elite reputation + proven builder, slightly less internal operational alignment than Valafar.

AI as a tool for success: Strong — built programs, secured funding

* **Understanding of AI systems:** Excellent — deep expertise (knowledge graphs, semantic AI)
* **AI design & governance:** Strong
* **Ethics & bias mitigation:** Moderate — not primary focus but likely competent
* **Public engagement:** Excellent — national reputation

👉 **Verdict:** Best for *external positioning, partnerships, and prestige*. Slightly less turnkey for internal coordination.

3. **Biplav Srivastava**

Why #3: Strongest in governance and ethics, but less broad strategic leadership.

* **AI as a tool for success:** Strong — enterprise + applied experience
* **Understanding of AI systems:** Strong
* **AI design & fairness:** Excellent — explicit expertise in responsible AI
* **Ethics & bias mitigation:** Excellent — standout strength
* **Public engagement:** Moderate–Strong

👉 **Verdict:** Ideal for building **policy, guardrails, and trust frameworks**. Slightly narrower than a full CAIO scope.

4. **Jianjun Hu**

Why #4: Strong technical and collaborative profile, but less leadership signal at institutional scale.

* **AI as a tool for success:** Moderate–Strong
* **Understanding of AI systems:** Strong (ML/data science)
* **AI design & governance:** Moderate
* **Ethics & bias mitigation:** Moderate
* **Public engagement:** Moderate

👉 **Verdict:** Solid contributor and collaborator, but not as clearly positioned for **top-level strategic leadership**.

5. **Leonardo Bonilha**

Why #5: Strong applied impact, but domain-specific (healthcare) limits breadth.

AI as a tool for success: Strong (within healthcare)

Understanding of AI systems: Strong (applied)

AI design & governance: Moderate

Ethics & bias mitigation: Moderate

Public engagement: Moderate–Strong

👉 **Verdict:** Excellent for **domain-specific AI transformation**, but less suited for **university-wide AI strategy**.

🧠 Key Insight

The ranking largely separates into three tiers:

Tier 1 (CAIO-ready now):

Valafar, Sheth

Tier 2 (Critical specialist leadership):

Srivastava

Tier 3 (Strong but not CAIO-level breadth):

Hu, Bonilha

📅 Bottom Line

* If you want **immediate execution and internal alignment** → Homayoun Valafar*

* If you want **prestige, partnerships, and national AI positioning** → Amit Sheth*

* If you want **strong governance and ethical foundation** → Biplav Srivastava*

If you want, I can convert this into a **formal hiring scorecard with numeric weights** or simulate how each candidate would perform in their **first 12 months as CAIO**.

d. .

a. Homayoun Valafar seems to be doing fine. He has a majority of the CAIO qualifications met currently.

b. .

- i. Ethical considerations for a good choice:
 - 1. Commitment to Responsible AI
 - 2. Respect for Academic Freedom
 - 3. Sensitivity to Student Rights and Vulnerabilities
 - 4. Understanding of Bias, Fairness, and Equity
 - 5. Transparency and Public Accountability
 - 6. Independence from Vendor Influence and Ability to Build Trust
- ii. Ramifications of a bad choice:
 - 1. Can violate student or staff privacy
 - 2. Can trigger protests or negative media attention
 - 3. Can potentially harm students or staff
 - 4. Can lose trust
 - 5. Can be a waste of money and resources